

PROFIT & LOSS

- Portfolio firms have expanded at a fast pace but some are still in losses due to quick expansion

OYO HOTELS & HOMES

	FY22	FY23	FY24
Total income	1,117	1,400.6	1,181.7
PAT	-353.1	-273.5	114.6

RAZORPAY SOFTWARE

	FY22	FY23	FY24
Total income	1,485.6	2,281.3	2,466.4
PAT	7.38	10.46	41.86

PHYSICSWALLAH LTD

	FY23	FY24	FY25
Total income	763.8	1,615.2	2,495.6
PAT	-76.7	-1,070.9	-135.6

ZETWERK MANUFACTURING BUSINESSES

	FY22	FY23	FY24
Total income	4,417.4	9,799.8	11,995.7
PAT	-58.24	-49.12	-674.28

ZEPTO

	FY22	FY23	FY24
Total income	142.3	2,077.6	4,178.3
PAT	-390.3	-1,271.8	-1,244.5

IN ₹CR; STANDALONE;
SOURCE CMIE PROWESS, ACE EQUITY



“Lightspeed has been in the trenches with us during critical decisions, whether it’s navigating business complexities or scaling up internationally. They think in decades, not quarters”

HARSHIL MATHUR
CO-FOUNDER,
RAZORPAY SOFTWARE LTD

CAUTION THE WATCHWORD

Even as Lightspeed has scaled from seed to growth-stage investing, its deal volume remains more measured than that of its peers. According to Tracxn, it has participated in 225 funding rounds across 105 Indian start-ups. In comparison, Accel has backed 210 companies through 574 rounds, while Peak XV Partners has invested in 189 companies across 485 rounds.

The same caution is visible in its exits. Lightspeed has recorded just one major exit—Innovaccer, with strong returns (approximately 30X)—and a partial exit from OYO. Accel and Peak XV, meanwhile, have been far more active, with nine and 19 exit rounds, respectively, says Neha Singh, co-founder and CEO of Tracxn.

Taneja says IPOs are a far more viable exit option today than five years ago, an avenue he believes will only widen in the next five. “This reflects the maturity of Indian public markets,” he says. “Investors now understand how startups operate, how their financial performance may differ from traditional companies, and how to value them. That’s evident from the way recent start-up IPOs have been wholeheartedly embraced by the market.”

AI, THE NEW OBSESSION

If the past decade for VCs was about payments, commerce, and content, the next one, will be about AI. India’s rapid adoption cycles have made it especially attractive for AI start-ups. As Hemant Mohapatra, another partner at Lightspeed, says, “The time it takes for transformational technologies to reach India has shrunk from 17 years to 12, then to 7, and now just 2–3. And the time to mass adoption has collapsed—from a decade for internet, to seven years for mobile, to three to four years for 4G/5G, and maybe two to three years for AI.”

The minuses: many elements of the foundational layer of AI-like large language models and graphic processing units are tightly controlled by Western entities, which have also begun to ring-fence strategic resources such as silicon design and talent mobility.

While Lightspeed India has taken a cautious approach to both investments and exits, 2026 could prove to be a watershed year for the company.

With a string of IPO-bound unicorns, the firm is on the cusp of proving that its bets were not just timely but transformational. **BT**

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